Core Design System 2.0

Mayes Digital Production Framework

Core Design System 2.0 is Mayes Digital's production framework, not another website template. ProofBook and ServicePro exposed what should be standardized. The system separates structure, layout, design tokens, components, and client branding so the same problems are not solved differently on every design.

1. Page Architecture

Core 2.0 commits to a four-layer section structure. Vertical spacing belongs to the section class. Horizontal page gutters remain a dedicated global utility inside the section.

```
section-small | section-medium | section-large
+ optional surface-*
+ optional radius-*
+ optional shadow-*
-> padding-global
-> container-*
-> section-content + is-row/is-column + gap-*
```

Section size classes

- section-small, section-medium, and section-large define the full-width section boundary and standardized vertical padding.
- Section size classes may be composed with surface, radius, and shadow utilities without changing structural behavior.
- Do not add horizontal page gutters to the section class.

padding-global

- Controls horizontal page gutters only.
- Does not control background, vertical spacing, max-width, layout direction, or component gaps.

Container

- Controls content max-width, uses width: 100%, and centers page content.

section-content

- Controls content layout through is-row or is-column.
- Internal spacing is applied separately with gap-* utilities.

Canonical example:

```
section-large surface-gradient shadow-medium
-> padding-global
-> container-xlarge
-> section-content is-column gap-8
```

2. Global Design Tokens

Spacing

Core 2.0 replaces arbitrary spacing values with a defined 4-point scale and semantic responsive variables. Component spacing remains stable where appropriate; larger layout spacing scales down across breakpoints.

- Spacing scale: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32
- Section vertical spacing is consumed by section-small, section-medium, and section-large.
- page-gutter is consumed by padding-global.

Container widths

- container-small
- container-medium
- container-large
- container-xlarge
- container-full

Most normal content should use one default container. Avoid slightly different max-widths created for individual sections.

3. Responsive System

Design intentionally across Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Landscape, and Mobile Portrait. Core 2.0 establishes common behavior before client design begins.

- 4-column: Desktop 4, Tablet 2, Mobile Landscape 1 or 2, Mobile Portrait 1.
- 3-column: Desktop 3, Tablet 2, Mobile 1.
- Split: Desktop 1fr 1fr, Tablet 1fr 1fr or stacked, Mobile stacked.

Use standardized layout primitives instead of repairing every card collection independently.

4. Typography System

Core establishes typography roles, not client fonts.

- Heading Display, H1, H2, H3, H4
- Body Large, Body, Body Small
- Eyebrow, Label, Caption, Utility, Button, Navigation

Each client design maps its brand fonts onto these roles. The system standardizes how typography works without forcing Mayes Digital's typography onto clients.

5. Color Architecture

Use semantic roles rather than design-specific color names.

- background-primary, background-secondary, background-inverse
- text-primary, text-secondary, text-muted, text-inverse
- border-primary, border-subtle
- brand-primary, brand-secondary, accent

6. Surface, Radius, and Shadow Utilities

Visual concerns are composable. A surface class must not own radius, shadow, padding, sizing, or layout.

Surface utilities

- surface-card
- surface-glass
- surface-elevated
- surface-gradient

surface-gradient controls only the gradient/background treatment and can be used on sections, cards, CTAs, and other elements.

Radius utilities

- radius-rounded - current semantic rounded treatment
- radius-pill - pill/capsule treatment

Additional radius scale utilities should be exposed only when repeated production use justifies them.

Shadow utilities

- shadow-small
- shadow-medium
- shadow-large

Shadow utilities contain only box-shadow. The legacy surface-shadow-* pattern is deprecated because it bundles unrelated responsibilities.

Example composition:

```
card surface-gradient radius-rounded shadow-medium
```

7. Layout Primitives

Core 2.0 provides reusable structural primitives rather than design-specific grids.

- section-content + is-row
- section-content + is-column
- gap-1 through gap-32 as defined in the spacing system
- Shared grid/split patterns where repeated production behavior justifies them

Avoid pricing-grid, service-grid, and features-grid classes when the underlying behavior is shared.

8. Component Library

Global

- Navbar, Footer, Button / Standard, Button / Large, icons, Logo, Breadcrumb

Content

- Section Heading, Eyebrow, Feature Card, Service Card, Testimonial Card, Pricing Card, FAQ Item, Stat, Badge, Icon + Text

Conversion

- CTA, Contact Form, Lead Form, Booking CTA

Media

- Image, Image Frame, Browser Frame, Device Frame, Gallery, Before / After, Video

Navigation / Interaction

- Tabs, Accordion, Dropdown, Slider, Lightbox

Whenever Webflow provides a quality native implementation, Core 2.0 defaults to native Webflow functionality.

9. Component Props

Props control content and legitimate client-level variation, not arbitrary design decisions.

- Good: Heading, Description, Image, Image Alt, Button Label, Button Link, Eyebrow, Badge, features, legitimate variant choices.
- Avoid: arbitrary padding, border radius, heading color, gap, or shadow values.

Decision rule: would this reasonably change when adapting the component for another client? If yes, consider a prop. If it is part of how Mayes Digital builds consistently, it belongs in Core.

10. Standard Section Patterns

- Hero / Split, Centered, Visual
- Features / 3 Card, 4 Card
- Services / Grid, Alternating
- Proof / Gallery, Before After, Testimonials
- Process / Steps, Pricing / Cards, FAQ / Two Column, FAQ / Single Column
- CTA / Split, CTA / Centered, Contact / Form

ProofBook and ServicePro can use different combinations of the same underlying system while remaining visually distinct.

11. Accessibility Built Into Core

- Correct semantic HTML
- Heading hierarchy rules
- Keyboard navigation
- Visible focus states
- Sufficient touch targets
- Form labels and accessible error states
- Descriptive alt-text architecture
- Appropriate ARIA where native HTML is insufficient
- Reduced-motion consideration
- Contrast-safe token combinations

Accessibility should be inherited from Core components, not discovered only during the final audit.

12. Interaction System

- Reveal, Fade, Rise, Scale, Stagger, Image Reveal, Accordion, Navigation
- duration-fast, duration-normal, duration-slow
- ease-standard, ease-enter, ease-exit

Native Webflow first. GSAP when justified. Custom JavaScript last.

13. CMS Architecture

Core 2.0 establishes reusable CMS patterns without forcing every collection into every website.

- Services, Projects, Testimonials, Team, Locations, Resources, Website Designs, Plans, FAQs

Field naming and architecture should be standardized so new projects do not require a fresh CMS schema every time.

14. SEO System

- One clear H1
- Logical H2/H3 structure
- Internal-link opportunities
- Image alt-text support
- SEO title
- Meta description
- OG title
- OG description
- OG image
- Canonical strategy
- Schema where appropriate

CMS templates should include SEO fields from the beginning.

15. Forms

Core contains production form patterns using native Webflow forms as the baseline.

- Contact Form, Lead Form, Quote Form, Booking Form, Newsletter Form

GoHighLevel or another platform is an integration layer rather than something the structural design depends on.

16. Core Pages

- Home / System Overview, Style Guide, Components, Patterns, CMS Examples, Forms, Instructions, Accessibility, SEO, Licenses / Internal Asset Register

The Style Guide is the visual control center rather than leftover documentation.

17. Build Workflow

```
CORE DESIGN SYSTEM 2.0
-> Duplicate
-> Apply Brand
-> Choose Patterns
-> Configure Components
-> Add Client Content
-> Configure CMS
-> QA
-> Launch
```

This replaces starting from a blank project, building ad hoc, repairing tablet/mobile afterward, and accumulating custom CSS.

Completion Gate

- Finsweet Client-First: structure and naming
- Apple Human Interface Guidelines: interaction quality and usability
- Webflow Marketplace quality standards: technical-quality benchmark with documented client-site exceptions
- Four-breakpoint responsive QA: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Landscape, Mobile Portrait
- Mayes Digital checks: Accessibility, SEO, Performance, Native Webflow preference, Component integrity, CMS integrity

The Biggest Architectural Change

Core 1.0 was essentially a starting website. Core Design System 2.0 is a website-building operating system. ProofBook and ServicePro become implementations of that system rather than templates that slowly develop their own rules.

Core 2.0 is the foundation for design #3 forward, with worthwhile improvements selectively migrated back into ProofBook and ServicePro.

Improvement / Risk

The biggest danger is overbuilding Core 2.0 into hundreds of utilities and variants. Standardize the 80% repeatedly used while preserving the remaining 20% for intentional design differentiation. The new compositional model reinforces this by keeping structure, surface, radius, shadow, and spacing independent.